

ILIKEITDEEP · A GUIDED JOURNAL

Love From a Distance

A Journal for Grieving Someone Still Living



printable pdf · 18 guided questions · for complicated grief

WELCOME

Before You Begin



There's a grief nobody brings casseroles for:
mourning someone who is still alive.
The parent you had to step back from. The friend who changed.
The person you love who you can't safely be near.

This grief is real, and it deserves real space.
That's what these pages are.

Loving someone from a distance means the love didn't end —
the access did. This journal helps you hold both truths
without tearing yourself in half.

If this grief sits on top of old wounds, a therapist can
help you carry it. Please don't carry it in silence.

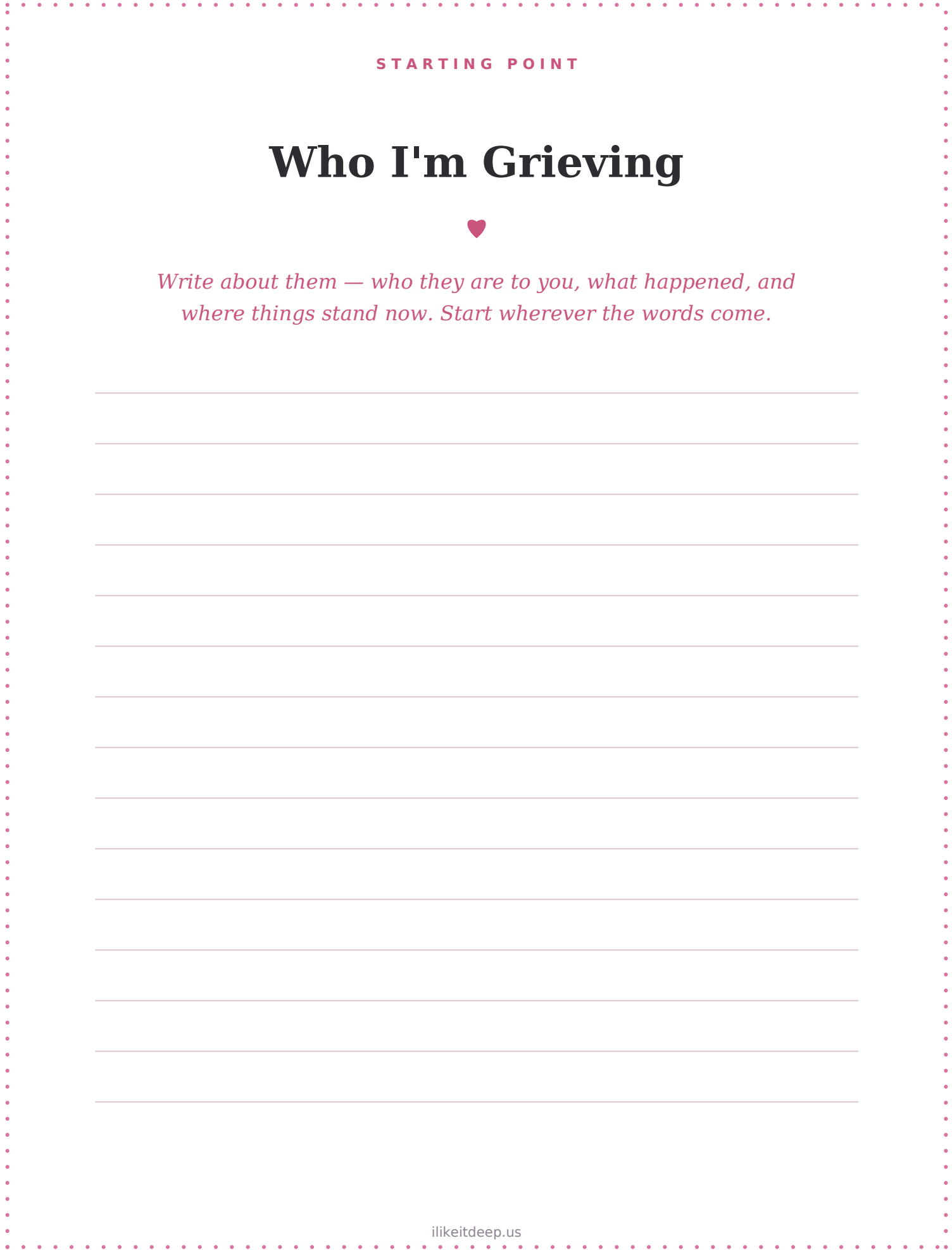
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STARTING POINT

Who I'm Grieving

Write about them — who they are to you, what happened, and where things stand now. Start wherever the words come.

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STARTING POINT

Who I'm Grieving

*Write about them — who they are to you, what happened, and
where things stand now. Start wherever the words come.*

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PART ONE

The Grief Nobody Sees



*Unwitnessed grief is still grief. Witness your
own here.*

What exactly are you grieving — the person, the relationship you had, or the one you never got?



*What moments hit you hardest — holidays, songs,
their birthday, ordinary Tuesdays?*

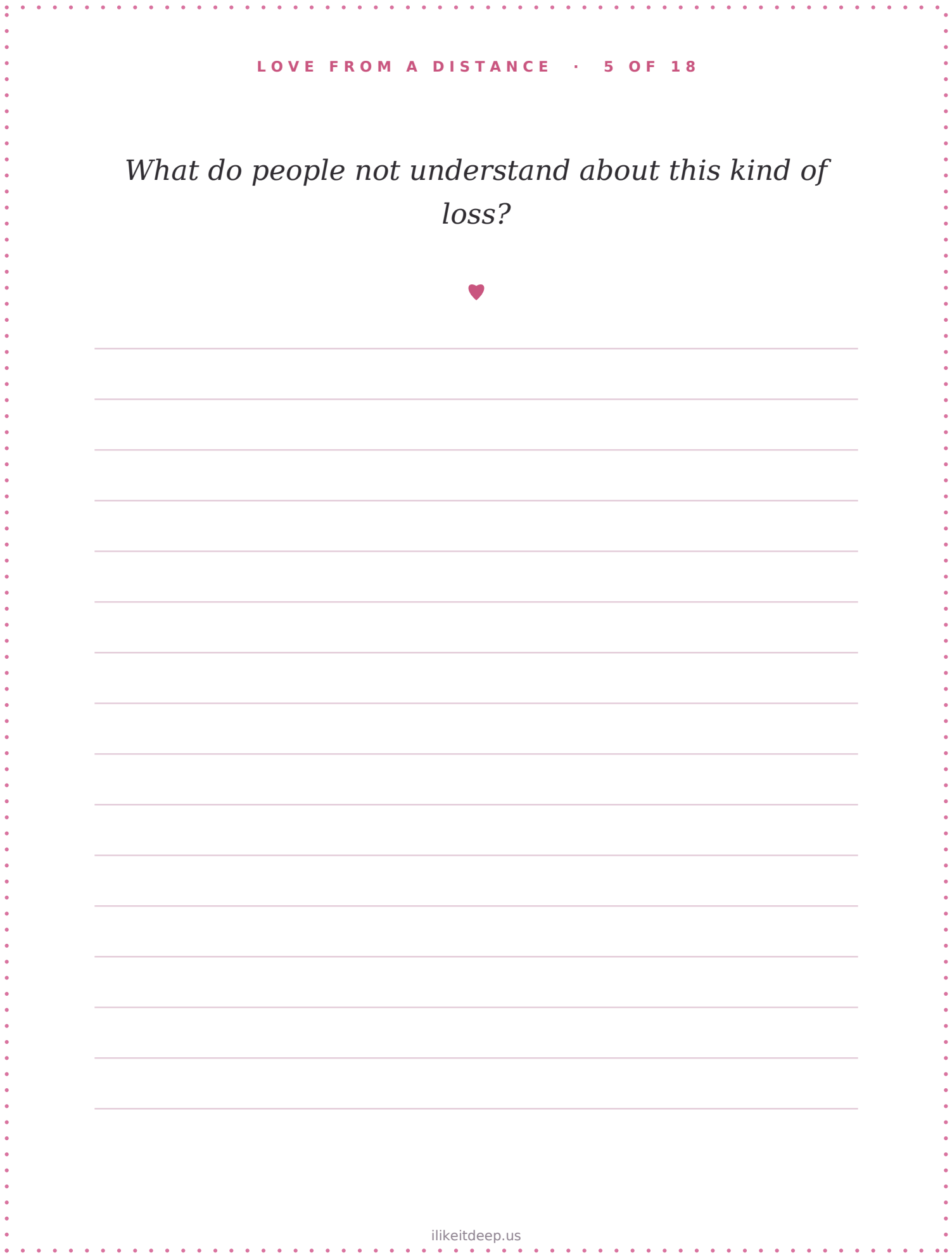


What do you miss that you're almost embarrassed to admit missing?



What made the distance necessary? Write it down so you can reread it on the wobbly days.



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LOVE FROM A DISTANCE · 5 OF 18

What do people not understand about this kind of loss?

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What feelings live side by side in you about them — love and anger, relief and guilt? List the pairs.



PART TWO

The Love and the Limit

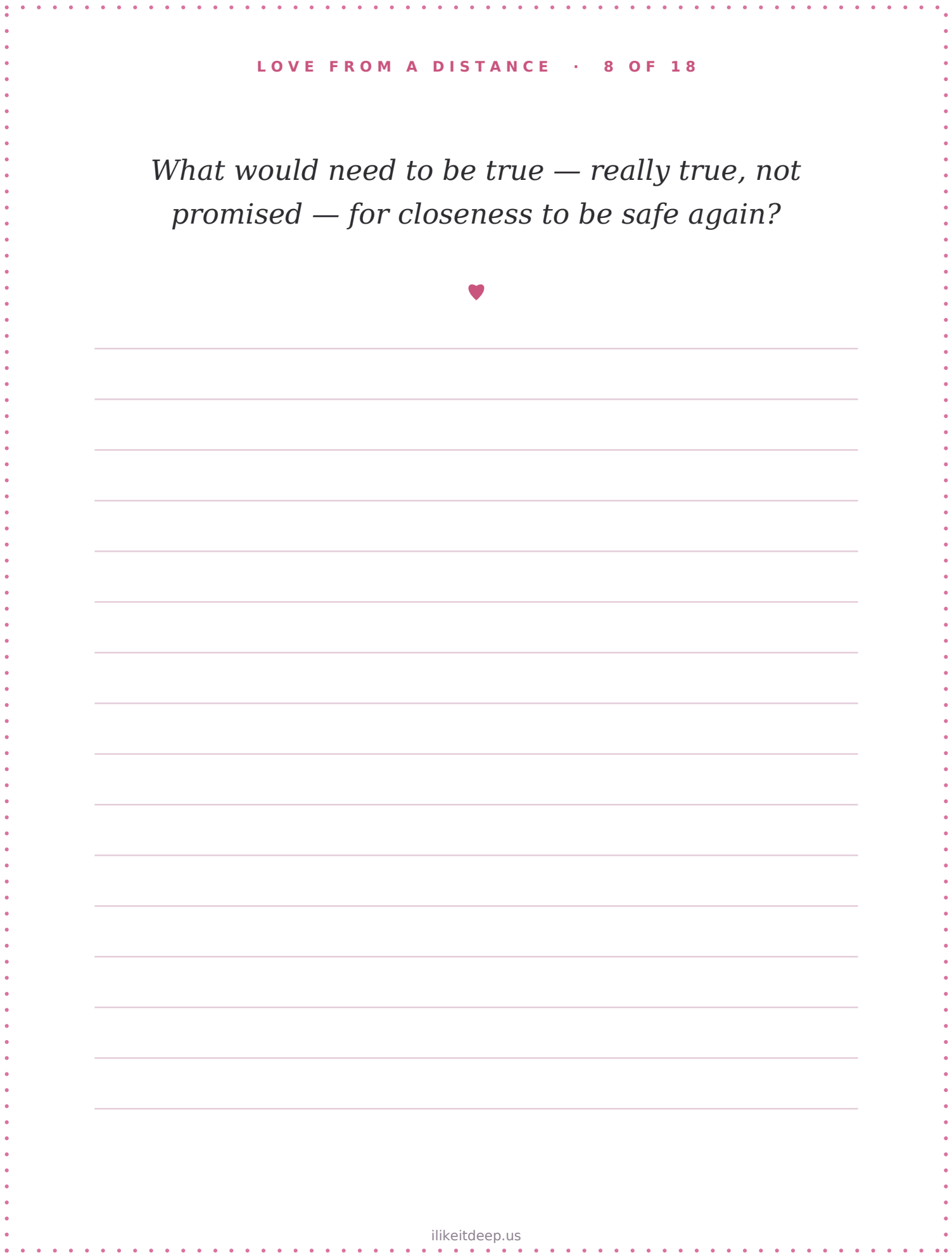


*A boundary is not the opposite of love.
Sometimes it's the last form love can take.*

LOVE FROM A DISTANCE · 8 OF 18

What would need to be true — really true, not promised — for closeness to be safe again?

♥



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LOVE FROM A DISTANCE · 8 OF 18

*What would need to be true — really true, not
promised — for closeness to be safe again?*

A small, solid red heart icon centered horizontally below the question.

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What guilt are you carrying about the distance, and what would you tell a friend carrying it?



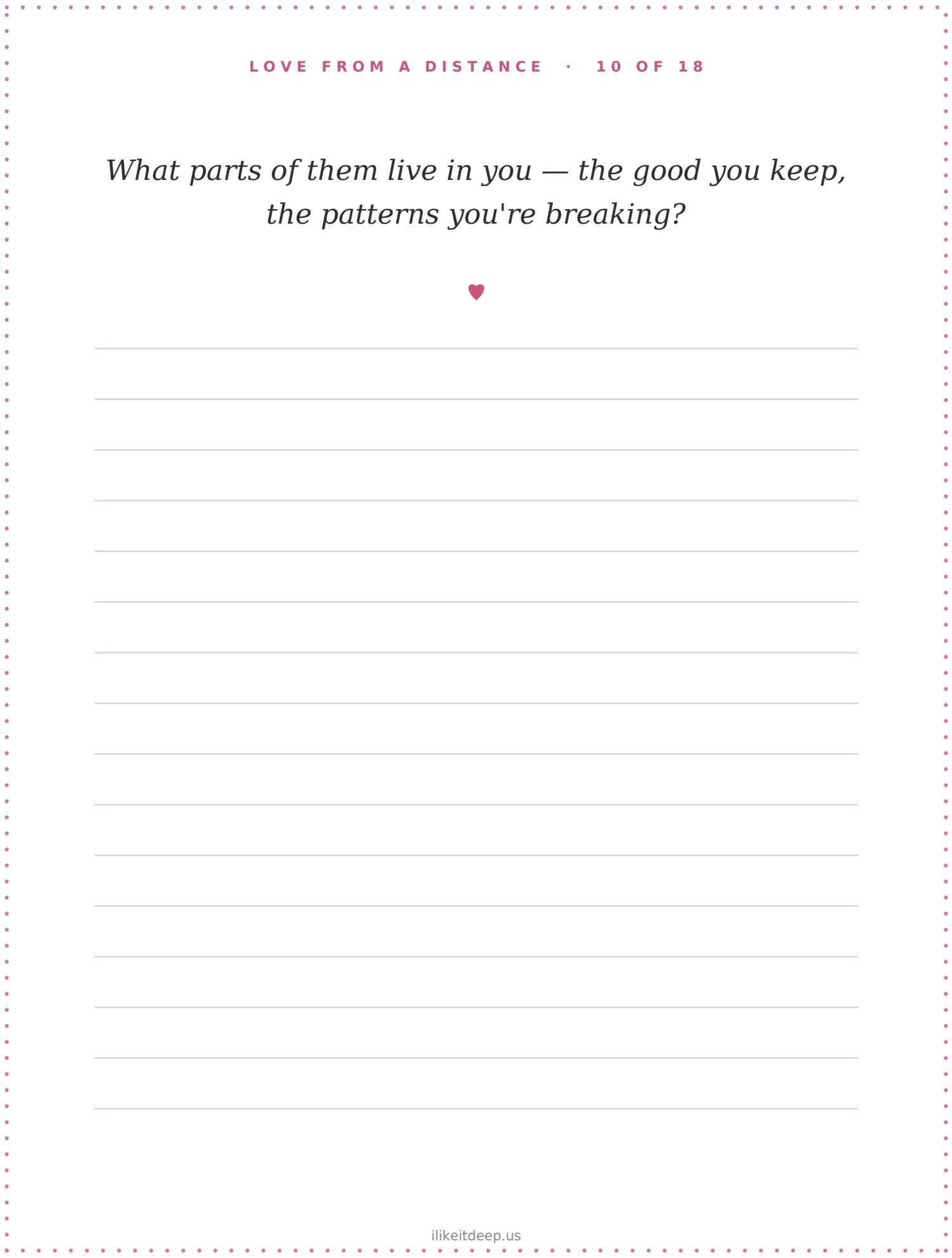
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LOVE FROM A DISTANCE · 10 OF 18

*What parts of them live in you — the good you keep,
the patterns you're breaking?*

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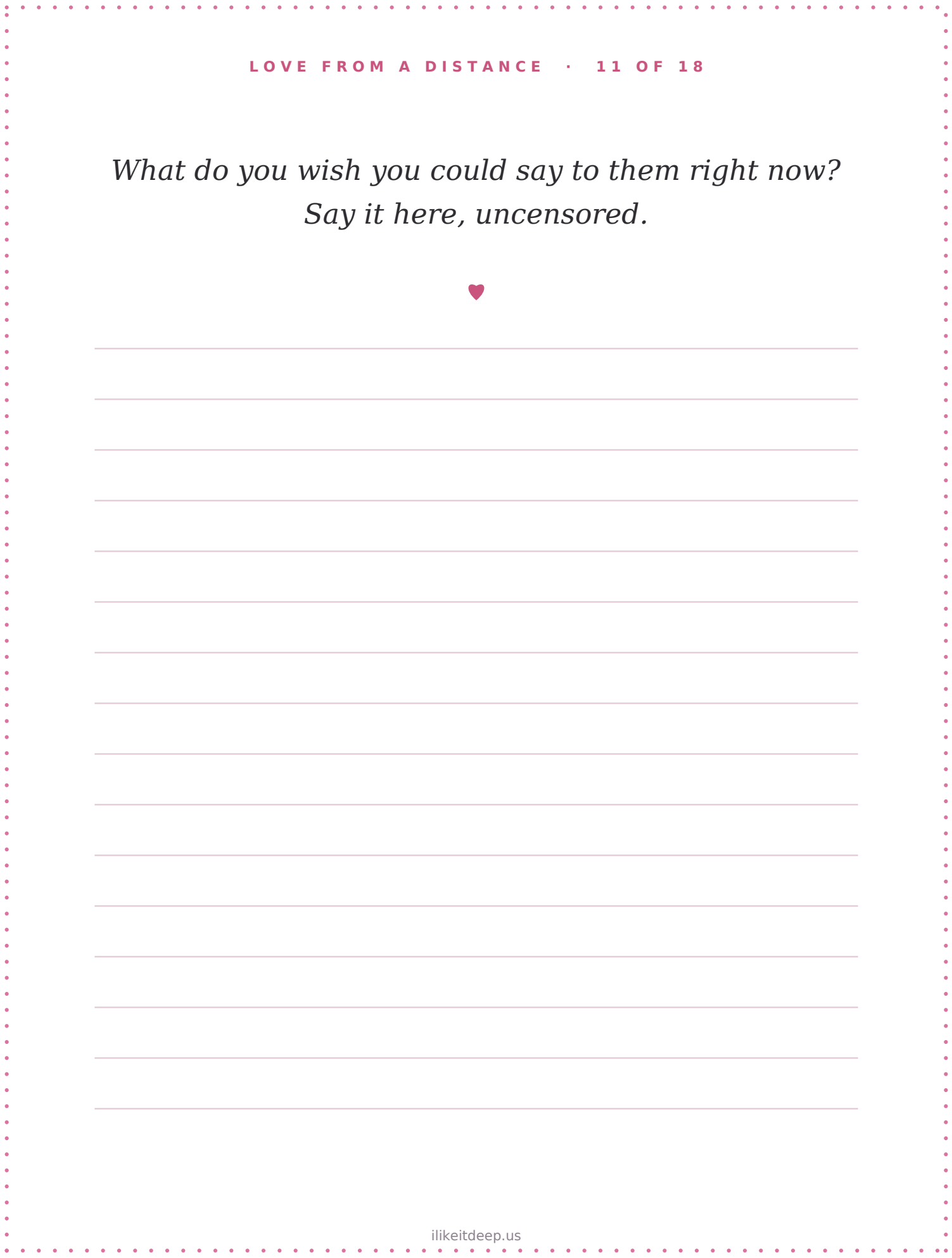
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LOVE FROM A DISTANCE · 10 OF 18

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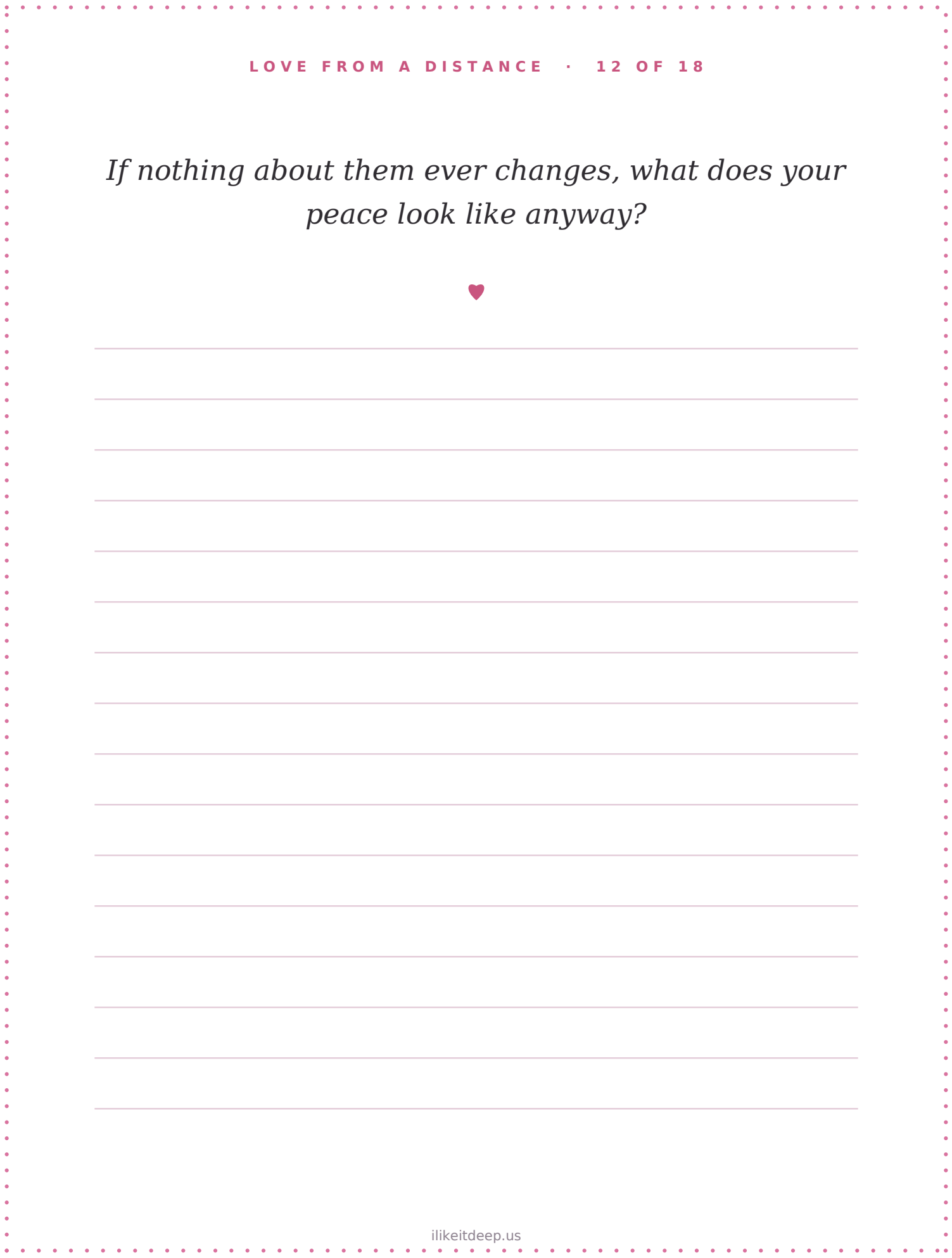
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LOVE FROM A DISTANCE · 12 OF 18

If nothing about them ever changes, what does your peace look like anyway?

A small, solid red heart icon centered horizontally below the question.

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LOVE FROM A DISTANCE · 12 OF 18

If nothing about them ever changes, what does your peace look like anyway?

A small, solid red heart icon centered horizontally below the question.

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PART THREE

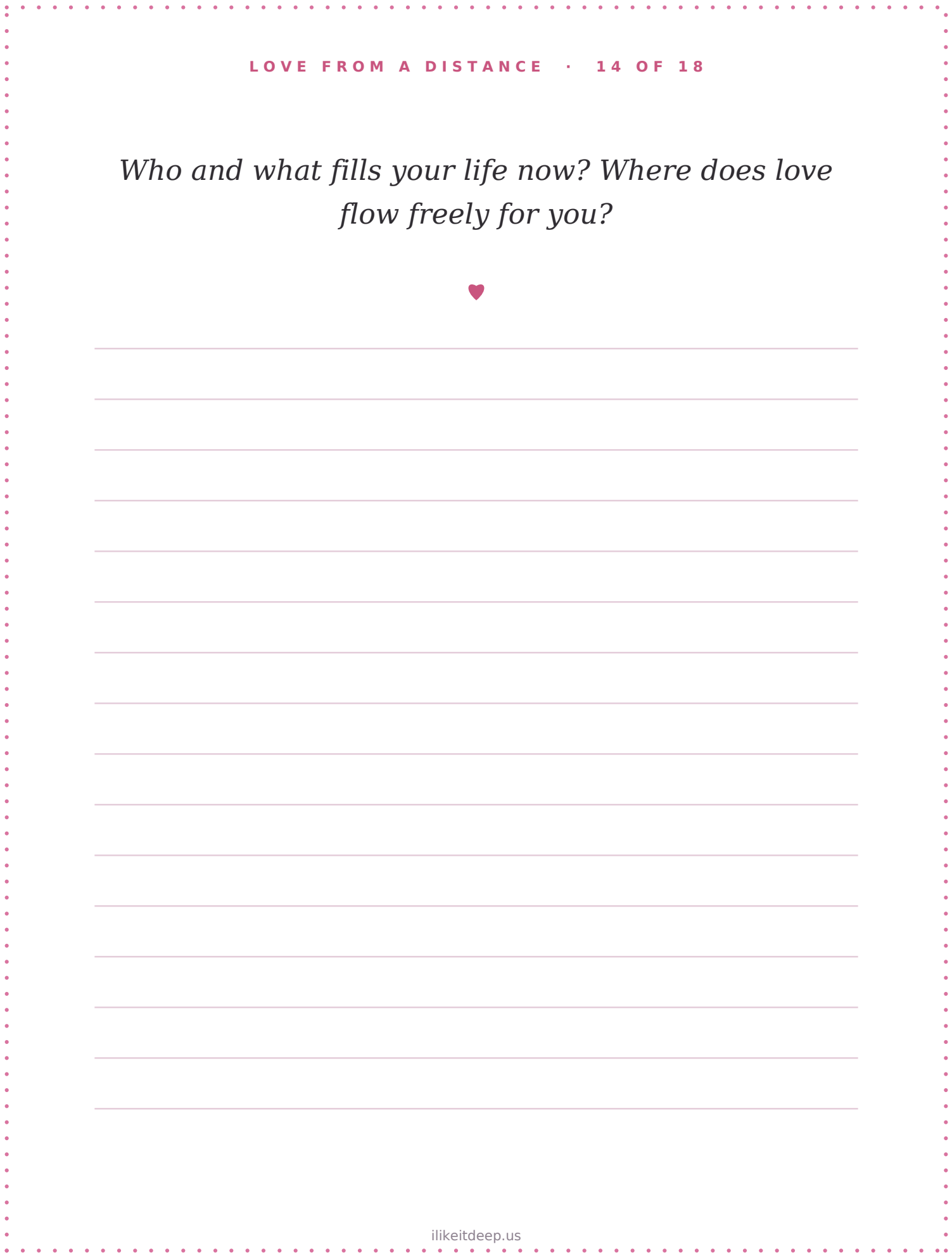
Living Forward

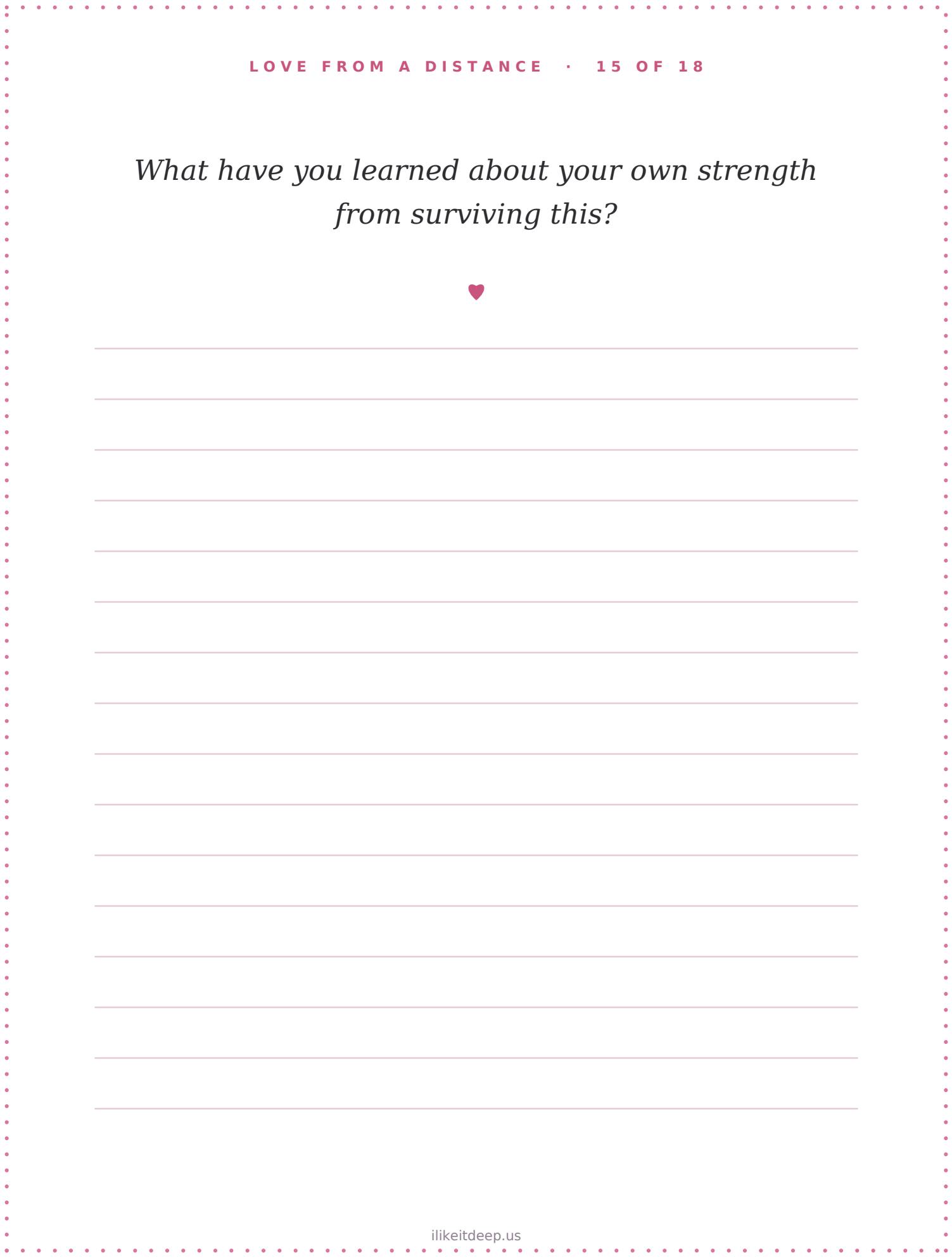


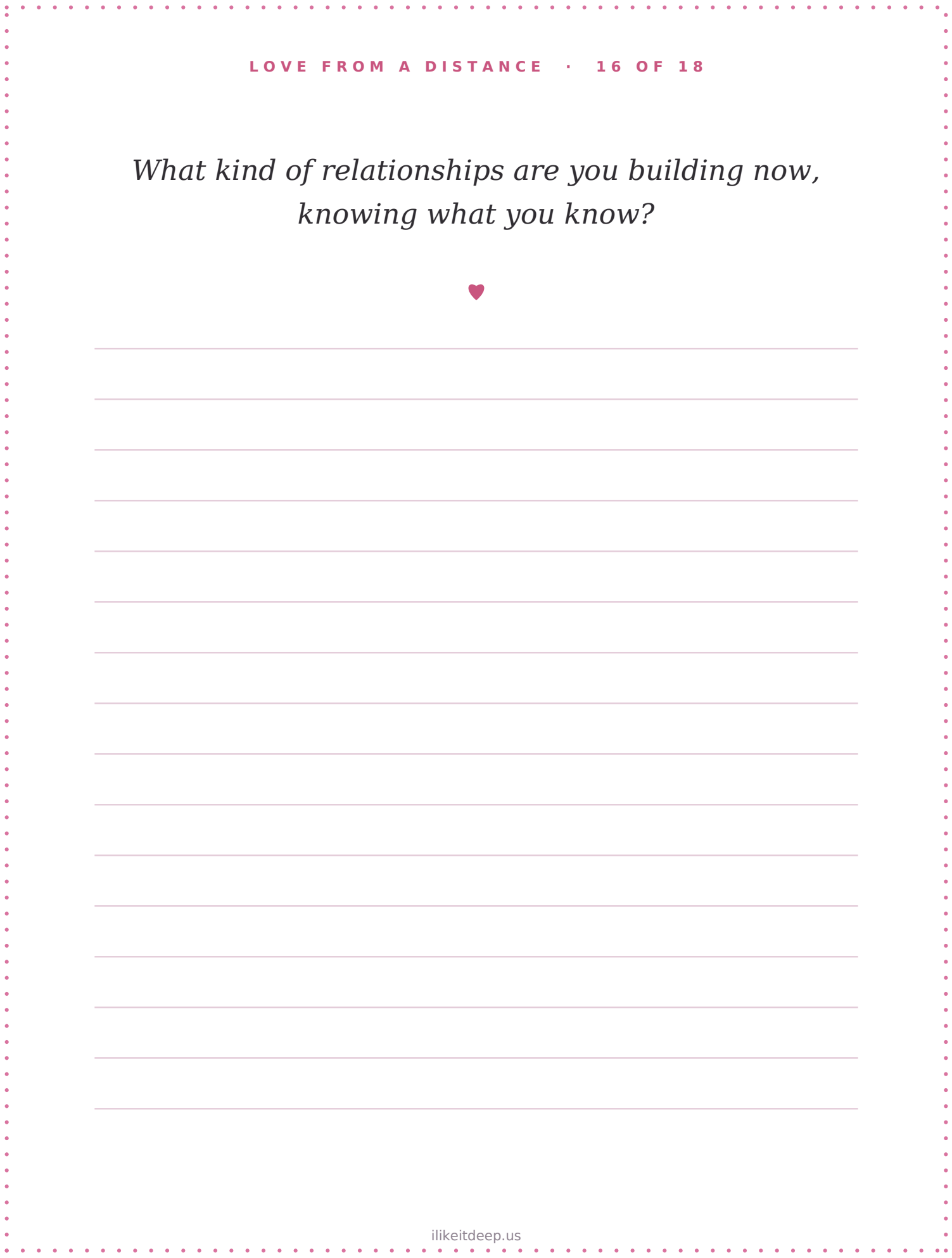
*You're allowed a full life that includes this
ache. Both can be true.*

*What rituals could honor the love without reopening
the wound — a candle, a letter never sent, a yearly
moment?*



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[illegible][illegible]

[illegible][illegible]

What hope, if any, do you keep — and what hope have you gently laid down?



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LOVE FROM A DISTANCE · 18 OF 18

Write yourself permission: to feel joy, to stop explaining, to live. Word it your way.

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LOVE FROM A DISTANCE · 18 OF 18

Write yourself permission: to feel joy, to stop explaining, to live. Word it your way.

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BONUS · FOR THE HARD DAYS

When the Missing Gets Loud



Anniversaries, holidays, random Tuesdays. Check the ones you'll reach for.

- ☐ Let yourself cry — set a timer if you need a container
- ☐ Write them a letter here that you'll never send
- ☐ Tell one person 'today is a hard day' — no explanation owed
- ☐ Do something kind in their honor instead of in their presence
- ☐ Reread your own words about why the distance exists
- ☐ Get outside — grief shrinks a little under open sky
- ☐ Hold something warm: tea, a bath, a blanket, a pet
- ☐ Play the song, feel it fully, then choose the next song
- ☐ Plan one small good thing for tomorrow
- ☐ Say out loud: 'I can love them and still protect me'

BONUS · KEEP THIS PAGE

What I Keep



*The good memories, the lessons, the parts of the love that are yours
forever. Distance can't touch this page.*

























BEFORE YOU CLOSE THIS JOURNAL

A Note, From One Human to Another



You've been doing one of the hardest things a heart can do:
loving someone and protecting yourself at the same time.

Grief for the living doesn't follow a schedule. It circles back.
Let it. Each time it visits, you'll be a little steadier.

And if this weight ever feels like too much to hold alone,
a therapist or grief group can help you hold it.
This kind of loss deserves that kind of care.



*The love didn't end. It just learned to
live at a distance.*



ilikeitdeep.us · stay deep